



THE ULTIMATE PRODUCT

Respite Navigator

A friendly chat that helps a caregiver find a few trustworthy hours off — for someone they love, without another form to fill in.

IN PLAIN TERMS

What it actually is

Respite Navigator is a conversation on your phone — the kind you'd have with a friend who happens to know every day-care centre, home-help service, and short-stay option near you. You describe your situation in your own words: who you're looking after, what kind of help would actually make a difference this week, and when you're free.

Within a couple of minutes it comes back with two or three real options nearby, explains in plain language why each one might fit, and helps you write the first message to ask about it. Nothing gets booked, called, or emailed without you saying yes first — it prepares the ground, you take the step.

The hackathon weekend builds the first working version of this. What's below is the fuller picture — where it goes if the team kept building past the deadline.

How it feels to use

01



You reach out

Text or voice, whenever you have five minutes — even 11pm. No form to fill in first.

02



Tell it, your way

"Mum needs mornings, I can afford about \$40." No medical forms, no jargon required.

03



A short real list

Not a thousand results — two or three that actually fit your hours, budget, and area.

04



A real reason why

"Runs weekday mornings, 10 minutes away" — an explanation, not just a score.

05



You take the step

It drafts the message. You read it, you send it.
You get your first morning off in weeks.

SEE IT IN ACTION

A real conversation

● Respite Navigator

hi, i look after my dad, he gets confused sometimes and i haven't had a morning to myself in weeks

11:47 PM

That sounds like a lot to carry.
Let's find you a few hours —
what days would help most, and
roughly what can you spend per
session?

11:47 PM

weekday mornings if possible.
maybe \$40-50

11:49 PM

TOP MATCH

Sunshine Corner Day Centre —
Mon-Fri mornings, memory-
support programme, 12 min
from you, ~\$45/session

Want me to draft a message
asking about a trial visit?

11:50 PM

yes please

11:50 PM

Ready for you to read and send
— nothing goes out without you.

11:50 PM

WHY NOT JUST GOOGLE IT

What it replaces

Searching online

Hours picking through search results and directories that might be years out of date —
you don't know what actually fits until you call each one yourself.

Calling a hotline

Genuinely helpful, but means explaining your whole situation out loud, during business hours you often don't have free.

Respite Navigator

Describe it once, in your own time. Get a short, actually-relevant list with reasons — any hour of the day, no queue.

BEYOND THE HACKATHON

Where it goes from here

V1 — THE HACKATHON WEEKEND

A working chat, tested on real scenarios

Matches what a caregiver describes against a small, hand-checked list of about fifteen local services, and drafts the first enquiry message for them to send.

V2 — A LIVING DIRECTORY

Partnered, always-current, and able to book

Working with eldercare providers directly so the list of services updates itself instead of going stale, and moving from "here's a message to send" to booking the slot for you, with your confirmation.

V3 — A COMPANION, NOT JUST A SEARCH

Notices what a search never would

Gently checks in when it's been a while since your last break — "it's been six weeks, want me to look again?" — and hands off to a real person on a support line the moment something is beyond what logistics can fix.

*"A few hours off, found in the time it takes to
make a cup of tea."*

Companion explainer to the IGNITE Hackathon Shortlist – see that page for the technical build plan behind V1.